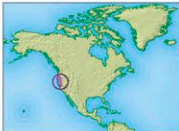


Batrachoseps attenuatus

California slender salamander



Length 3–5½ in (7.5–14 cm)
Habit Wholly terrestrial
Breeding Not known season
Status Least concern

Location W. USA (California, Oregon)



This salamander lives mainly underground and under logs and rocks, emerging at night after rain. Its extremely long, slender body enables it to enter very small crevices. It is dark brown or black, with a brown, yellow, or red stripe along the back, and tiny, 4-toed limbs. When in danger, the California slender salamander coils and uncoils its tail rapidly, and may shed it if attacked.



Pseudotriton ruber

Red salamander



Length 4–7 in (10–18 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Any time of year, season usually summer
Status Least concern

Location E. and S.E. USA



Brilliantly colored when young, but becoming progressively darker with age, the red salamander is found in damp places, springs, and cool streams in many eastern states of the USA.



It has a thick body, a relatively short tail and legs, and a dense scattering of black spots over its red or orange-red skin. Largely nocturnal, it feeds mainly on invertebrates and other salamanders. To ward off predators, the red salamander raises its tail and waves it, but its color may also act as a defense. Although it is harmless, its red markings closely resemble those of the toxic young eastern newts (see p.444)—a similarity that may be a form of protective mimicry. The female lays about 70 eggs, attached to the underside of logs or rocks, and sometimes in water. Adult red salamanders usually spend the winter underground.

Aneides lugubris

Arboreal salamander



Length 4¼–7 in (11–18 cm)
Habit Terrestrial/Arboreal
Breeding Not known season
Status Least concern

Location W. USA (California)



This long, slender, brown and white salamander has flattened toe tips and a prehensile tail that enable it to climb trees with ease. The relatively large, triangular head contains prominent jaw muscles that are used in fights between individuals, or in defense—for instance, against predatory snakes. It lives below ground in winter and dry weather. The female lays 12–18 eggs in an underground chamber.



Bolitoglossa mexicana

Mexican mushroom-tongue salamander

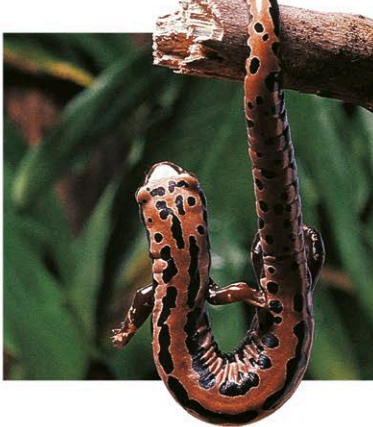


Length 4¼–6 in (12–15 cm)
Habit Arboreal/Terrestrial
Breeding Any time, except season dry/cold periods
Status Least concern

Location S. Mexico to Central America



With its prehensile tail, feet with adhesive pads on the base, and small size, this nocturnal animal is specially adapted for climbing trees and moving around on the smallest of branches. It has a mushroom-shaped tongue, which it flicks out to catch insects. The bronze or pink coloring, with black marbled patterning, acts as a warning that this salamander will emit noxious secretions from its skin if attacked.



Ensatina eschscholtzii

Ensatina salamander



Length 2¼–3¼ in (6–8 cm)
Habit Wholly terrestrial
Breeding Fall to spring season
Status Least concern

Location W. USA



This nocturnal animal lives in damp leaf litter and under logs, and is especially active after rain. It has a short body, long legs, and prominent eyes. Its color depends on the area in which it lives: it may be uniformly brown, or black with white, yellow, orange, or pink blotches. The round tail, which narrows abruptly at the base, is used in defense. The salamander lifts it up and waves it around, emitting a distasteful secretion to deter predators; it may also shed its tail if attacked. During the breeding season, the male has a longer tail and develops a swollen cloaca. The female lays 8–20 eggs in clusters under logs.

Oedipina quadra

Honduran lowland worm salamander



Length 4¼–7½ in (12–19 cm)
Habit Terrestrial
Breeding Not known season
Status Not evaluated

Location Central America



This is one of many new species of rain-forest salamanders discovered in Central America in recent years. It was found while sorting through leaf litter of pristine wet broadleaf forest

in Honduras—and gets its name from its elongated body and tiny limbs. It is jet black on upper parts and sides, slightly paler underneath; its tail is nearly rectangular in cross section—hence its scientific name. The species belongs to a family of American lungless salamanders (including Plethodon, Bolitoglossa and allies) that breathe through their moist skin. They have diversified into more than 200 species in the wet forests of Central and northern South America, where they feed on tiny invertebrates, such as springtails. These tropical salamanders do not need free-standing water to breed because they have evolved direct development: eggs laid in the moist habitat hatch into miniature forms of adults, bypassing an aquatic larval stage.

Eurycea guttolineata

Three-lined salamander



Length 4–7 in (10–18 cm)
Habit Wholly terrestrial
Breeding Fall and season early winter
Status Least concern

Location E. USA



A long and slender body with 13 or 14 costal grooves, prominent eyes, and a very long tail characterize this salamander. It is yellow,

orange, or brown, with dark brown or black stripes down the middle of its back and along the sides. It lives under logs and rocks in damp areas near springs and streams; winters and dry periods are spent underground. Spiders, flies, beetles, and ants are the main diet of this predator, which feeds at night,



especially after it has rained. During the breeding season, the male develops 2 fleshy projections on the upper lip, 2 protruding teeth, and a swollen cloaca. Eggs are laid in damp cavities.